



LaunchPad

Brand guide. Blue, gold **and** black.

How LaunchPad looks, sounds and behaves, and why. Every value here is contrast-checked and lives in code as a token, so the site can't drift from it.

A launch pad, not a billboard.

LaunchPad teaches money and business to 15–21-year-olds who don't have an adviser or a family member to ask, in an edition for the money system each reader actually lives in. The brand has to read as trustworthy, calm and grown-up, the opposite of the loud "get rich" aesthetic these readers are surrounded by, while still feeling made for them.

The thesis in one line: quiet, precise, and pointed upward. Structure and controls are conventional so nothing needs learning; identity lives in the type, the one accent, the navy, and one or two signature moments per page.

The three colours, in their roles

Deep navy

#0B1240 · the anchor. Logo tile, dark sections, deepest surface.

Marigold

#F2C14E · the spark. Logo, highlights, a callout tint. Never small text on white.

Ink black

#0B0B0F · the words. Headings, primary text, the dark-mode canvas.

Signal blue

#0C61C4 · the work. Buttons, links, focus. White text on it: 6.0:1.

Paper white

#FFFFFF · the canvas.

Surface 2

#F5F6F8 · cards and alternating bands.

How they're spent

Navy is used generously (sections, the logo). Blue does every action. Gold appears once or twice per screen at most. Everything else is black, greys and white. If a screen has more gold than blue, it's wrong.

Every pair has a number.

WCAG 2.2 AA needs 4.5:1 for text and 3:1 for large text and non-text. These are the figures `npm run contrast` prints; a miss fails the build.

Token	Hex	On white	Use
 --ink	#0B0B0F	19.6:1	Headings, primary text
 --ink-2	#3C3F47	10.5:1	Body text
 --muted	#5F6472	5.9:1	Secondary text, captions
 --accent / --accent-text	#0C61C4	6.0:1	Button fill (white text 6.0:1), links, focus ring
 --gold-text	#7A5A0E	6.4:1	Eyebrow labels: the one place gold becomes text
 --gold	#F2C14E	1.7:1 X	Fill or mark only. Black on it: 11.7:1
 --error	#C42B1C	5.7:1	Errors
 --success	#1B7F4E	5.0:1	Confirmations

Dark mode is a designed set, not an inversion

Canvas
#0B0B0F

Surface 2
#16171C

Surface 3
#1F2027

Navy
#0B1240

Token	Hex	On canvas	Note
 --ink	#F5F5F7	18.0:1	Softened white, never pure
 --accent-text	#8FBEFF	10.3:1	Links brighten; the blue fill stays #0C61C4
 --gold / --focus	#F2C14E	11.7:1	Gold passes as text in dark, so focus and eyebrows go gold
 --muted	#9A9EAB	7.4:1	Secondary text

Two faces. One has character, one has clarity.

Learn how money actually works.

Bricolage Grotesque 700 • display, headlines, big numbers, the wordmark • tracking
-0.025em • SIL OFL

Break-even: how many cups before you profit?

Bricolage Grotesque 600 • section headings

₹1,00,000 • \$2,450 • 286 cups • 7.1%

Figures use tabular numerals so columns line up; money is formatted per locale (en-IN groups as lakhs)

LaunchPad is free, has nothing to sell, and is written for people aged 15 to 21 who don't have an adviser or a family member to ask. Body text is Atkinson Hyperlegible Next, designed by the Braille Institute so that I, l and 1, or O and 0, can't be confused, which matters on cheap screens in bright light.

Atkinson Hyperlegible Next 400 • body and UI • 17px on screen, never smaller than 15px •
SIL OFL

Token	Size	Use
--text-display	40 → 76px	Home hero only
--text-h1	36 → 60px	Page titles
--text-h2	28 → 40px	Section headings
--text-h3	20 → 24px	Card and sub headings
--text-lg	19 → 21px	Lede paragraphs
--text-md / sm / xs	17 / 15 / 13px	Body / captions / fine print

An L that launches.

The upright of the L is a launch arrow in marigold; the foot is the pad in blue; the tile is navy. It reads as a rocket and a letter at once, and it uses all three brand colours in their correct roles.



Rule	Value
Clear space	At least the height of the arrowhead on every side
Minimum size	20px for the mark; 24px in the header; the wordmark drops on phones, the mark stays
Wordmark	Bricolage Grotesque 700, tracking -0.02em, ink (or #F5F5F7 on dark)
Files	public/brand/logo-mark.svg, logo-lockup.svg, logo-lockup-dark.svg, favicon.svg, icons/ (PWA + maskable), og-default.png

Don't



Gradients or a glow



Stretching



Swapping the colour roles



Adding taglines or badges

And, per Apple's own rule, the logo is not wallpaper: it appears in the header and the footer and nowhere else. Branding defers to content.

Pills, flat cards, hairlines, one shadow.

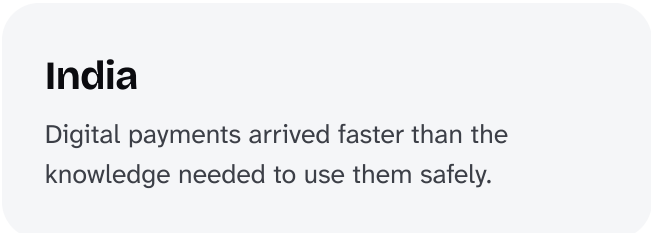
Buttons



Why this exists ›

44px pills. One primary per view. Sentence case, a verb first.

Card



Flat #F5F6F8, 20px radius, no border, no shadow. One card style everywhere.

Eyebrow + callout

Why it exists

In 30 seconds. A small gold-tinted panel for the takeaway. Black text on a 20% marigold mix; never gold text on white.

Radius and depth

Controls / inputs	12px
Cards	20px
Buttons, tabs	999px (pill)
Shadow	One: --shadow-signature, on the hero preview only
Depth otherwise	Surface colour (white → grey → navy) and a frosted sticky header

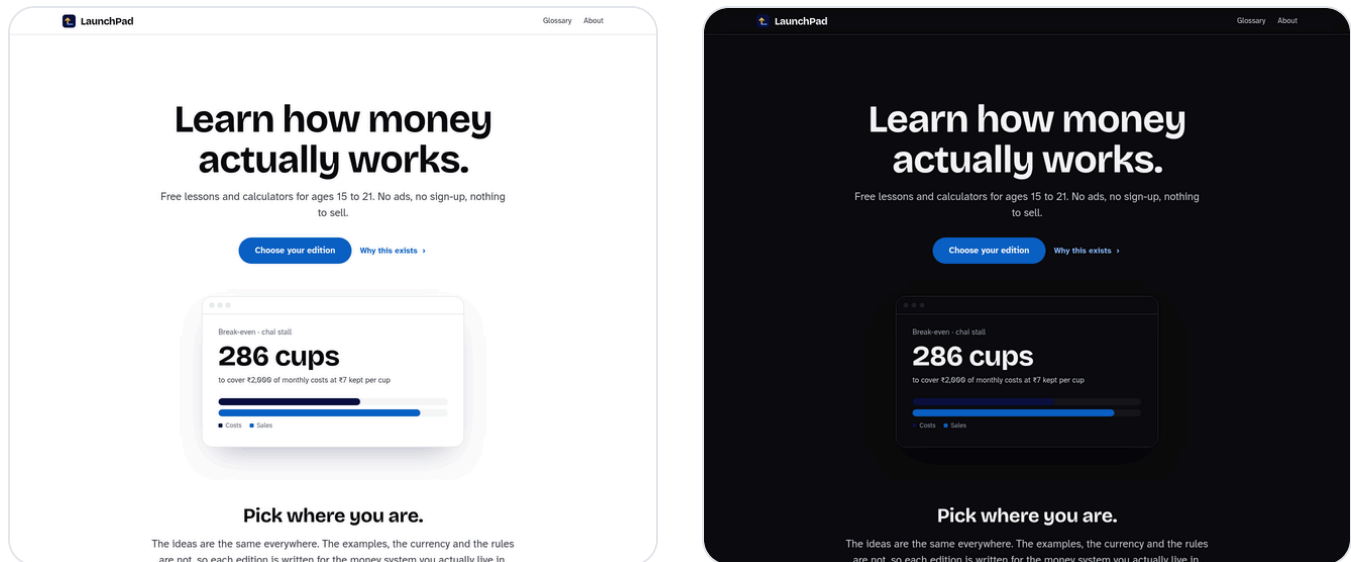
Motion

Functional and brief ($\leq 500\text{ms}$): a short cross-page fade, content rising 14px as it enters, a bar that grows once. All of it is behind prefers-reduced-motion and none of it carries meaning on its own. Nothing animates on frequent interactions.

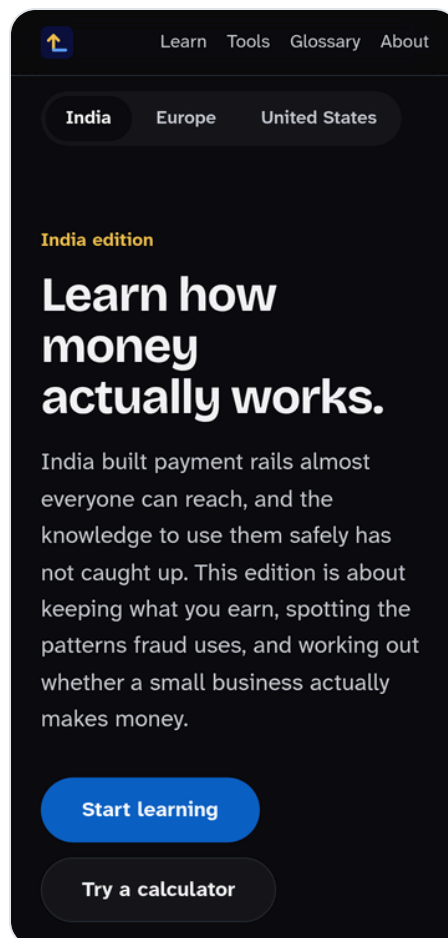
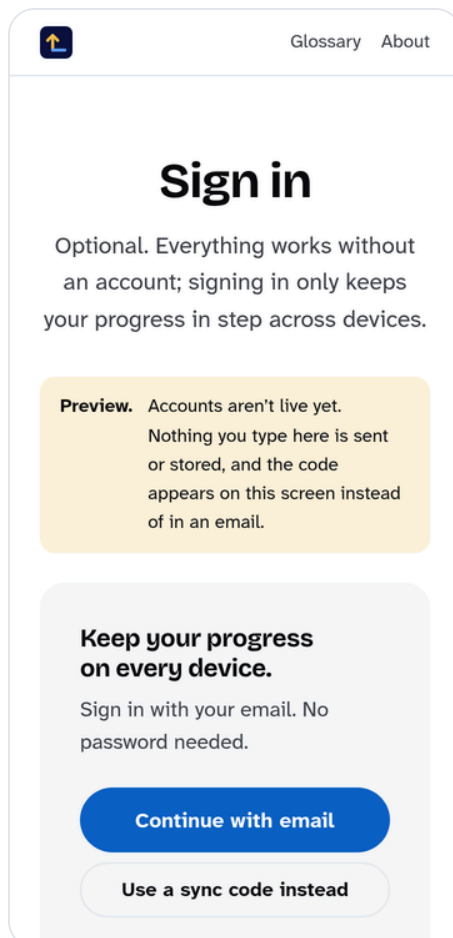
Charts

Categorical series in fixed order, validated for colour-vision safety in both modes (the dataviz palette checker): 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8. Every chart carries direct labels and a data table; one axis, never two; marigold is not a chart colour.

The system on a real page.



Home at 1280px, light and dark: a centred six-word headline, one blue action, one text link, the calculator preview with the single signature shadow, then three flat edition cards.



Voice

Plain, direct, peer-level, never hype. Sentence case everywhere. Verbs on buttons. Numbers with units and a source. No "Oops", no exclamation marks in UI. Say when something is hard. The tone is a smart older sibling who has read the rules, not a brand.

Words we don't use: unlock, supercharge, seamless, revolutionary, game-changer, effortless, "your financial journey", empower.

Ship only if it passes all ten.

This is what keeps LaunchPad from looking generated. The design-reviewer subagent in `.claude/agents` enforces it on every change.

- 1. No eyebrow badge or pill floating over a centred hero; the eyebrow is a small text label.
- 2. No stat banner of three identical numbers with no source. Every figure carries its sentence and its link.
- 3. No three-column grid of identical icon-in-rounded-square cards.
- 4. No gradient (especially blue→purple), no glow, no glassmorphism as decoration.
- 5. Not the default font. Not ALL CAPS labels. Not emoji as icons.
- 6. Section sizes vary; the page is not five equal stacked bands.
- 7. Copy is specific and numeric, not "powerful, seamless, effortless".
- 8. One bold thing per screen; everything around it is quiet.
- 9. Works in light and dark, at 360px and 1280px, at 200% zoom, with reduced motion.
- 10. Every colour and size is a token; no inline styles (the Content Security Policy blocks them anyway).

Where the machine version lives

src/styles/tokens.css	Every colour, size, radius, duration, in light and dark
docs/BRAND_GUIDE.md · docs/DESIGN.md	This guide in text, and how it is built in code
scripts/contrast-check.mjs	Prints every contrast pair; fails on a miss (npm run contrast)
scripts/screenshots.mjs	360/1280 light/dark screenshots of every key page (npm run screenshots)
.claude/agents/design-reviewer.md	The reviewer that checks the ten points